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TONNETTE KENNER USN

SPECIAL
POINTS OF
INTEREST:

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Kenner Chronicle

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Over-Mountain Man Francis Kenner II

Francis Kenner II (DAR Ancestor #: A064845, NSSAR Ancestor # P-228660) the Founder of the Kenner Tennessee line, was born in 1734 in Fauquier Co. VA the son of Margaret (daughter of Col George Eskridge) and Major Howson Kenner. In 1756 he married Elizabeth Howard. They lived for several years on land in Prince William Co. VA leased from America's Founding Father George Mason. Here several of their children were born. In Oct 1778 they settled in the Watauga (today this is 1 mile from Rogersville, TN in Hawkins Co.). This makes the Kenner Family a "First Family of Tennessee"! In 1779 he was taxed in Washington Co on 4 negroes, 5 horses, and 3 cattle, but no land.

Then the Revolutionary War came to the South. Francis and his son Rodham served as Riflemen under Thomas Houghton who was under Colonel John Sevier (the first Governor of Tennessee) in one of the bloodiest and most important battles of the entire war, Kings Mountain. There 800 Patriots volunteered without orders, formal military training, uniforms, provisions, using only hunting rifles and with no promise of pay stood to fight a larger Loyalist army that outnumbered, outgunned, who held a superior position and were led by British war hero Major Patrick Ferguson, inventor of the breech-loading musket.

The Over-Mountain Men, as these Patriots were called, marched all night through pouring rain. At dawn on 7 Oct 1780 the Patriots formed eight groups



Sycamore Shoals State
Historic Park
 Elizabethton, TN.

of 100 of men. Col Sevier led one of the groups to assault the 'high heel', the highest point of mountain, while the other seven groups attacked the main Loyalist position by surrounding the base of the mountain. Sevier's men exposed themselves to intense fire as they scaled the summit. Ferguson rallied his troops and launched a bayonet charge against them. When the charge failed, Ferguson grew desperate and slipped on a plaid shirt to cover his officer's coat. A Patriot saw this and alerted his fellow soldiers. The Patriots then overran the Loyalist position, Ferguson fell dead from his saddle with eight rifle balls in his body. Seeing their leader fall, the Loyalists began to surrender. In only 65 minutes the battle was over. All Loyalists had been killed or captured.

The Patriot victory at Kings Mountain "re-energized a down-trodden Continental Congress." Thomas Jefferson called it "The turn of the tide of success." Teddy Roosevelt later wrote, "This brilliant victory marked the turning point of the American Revolution." The victory destroyed the left flank of Cornwallis' army, forced Lord Cornwallis to retreat from Charlotte, and gave Gen Nathanael Greene the opportunity to reorganize the American Army. And the Kenner Family was there! Today King's Mountain is a National Military Park.

On 12 June 1783 Specie Certificates were issued to Francis and was applied to the purchase of 500 acres of land on the Holston River (about one mile from Rogersville, TN) on 8 Mar 1784. On 8 Aug 1784 Francis died of smallpox which also claimed his wife's eyesight. Today there are still descendants of Francis living in the Rogersville area. There is a Kenner Road and the historic Clay-Kenner House located at 403 E Main St.

Francis and Elizabeth had 9 children: Howson, Francis III, Rodham, Rosamond (who married Daniel Hamblen), Nancy (who married Milton Senter and had 8 children), Winder, Elizabeth (who married John Huntsmen), Margaret and Colonel Eskridge.

Midshipman Dr. Howson Kenner II

Howson Kenner II was born in Prince William Co. VA on land leased from America Founding Father George Mason about 1757. Upon his father's death, he moved his family to his father's land on the Holston River. He served in the Revolutionary Navy on the Dragon Ship. The Dragon Ship was commissioned by George Washington and built by Fielding Lewis, Washington's brother-in-law. This project was dear to George Washington, overlooking every detail. Howson and his cousin Rodham Kenner served as officers, Midshipman, under Capt. James Markham. (Markham wedded Kate Kenner.) They were captured by the British and kept in Dartmore Prison, where they were badly treated and nearly

starved. They made their escape by bribing the jailer, got into a wherry, and put out to sea. They were captured by the French and taken to France. They were reportedly released by the influence of the Marquis de Lafayette, and sent home to America. Howson later became a Doctor. Howson received a land grant from the State of Virginia as follows: *"Land Office Military Warrant, No. 3782 To the principal Surveyor of the lands set apart for the officers and Soldiers of the Commonwealth of Virginia. This shall be your warrant to survey and lay off in one or more surveys for HOWSON KENNER his heirs and assigns, the quantity of Two thousand Six hundred and Sixty six and 2/3 acres of land, due unto the said Howson KENNER. In consideration of his services for Three years as midshipman in the Virginia State Navy. Agreeable to a certificate from the Governour and*

Council received unto the Land Office. Given under my hand, and the seal of the said office this 21st day of March in the year one thousand seven hundred and 85."

He received another land grant of 254 acres in May 1789. On 26 Dec 1795, he received a land grant for 640 acres in Hawkins Co. He married Lucy Callahan in 1786 and had 7 children. His first son was William was born in 1788 and married Elizabeth (daughter of Isaac Mendenhall from Scotland) in 1816. In 1817 fathered the Honorable Rev. Elias Housen Kenner (see Kenner Chronicle Vol. 1). William died in 1829. Another son Markham whom he named after his uncle. On 29 June 1828 Howson died in Hawkins County, TN.

Francis Kenner III



William B Kenner tombstone

Francis III was born about 1757 and married Elizabeth Pillars and had 15 children. Francis was a wealthy citizen and a great sportsman. He came to Missouri when it was Louisiana Territory. The official history of St. Genevieve Co. states:

"Francis Kenner had lived near Rogersville, Tennessee. He arrived at New Madrid, MO in 1801. Two years later, he purchased 640 acres on the Cedar Fork of Saline Creek in Perry County. The following year, he located in Ste. Genevieve County near Minnith. This farm was later owned by his son Housen. On June 14, 1804 he married Elizabeth Pillars and built a house on the Big Saline. Here he successfully engaged in farming, and in speculating in land,

owning 2,700 acres at one time. He was a breeder of fine horses and kept several fast horses. In June, 1811, the creek overflowed its banks and destroyed his crops. The water was 2 feet deep in his house. He planted apple trees on his farm in 1807, which were still alive in 1888. He died on December 30, 1830, leaving his family a fine property in land and slaves."

Francis III was the first Kenner in Missouri before it was a state, making the Kenner's a First Family of Missouri (Territorial Certificate). Of his youngest son William B. (who never meet his father since his father died before his birth) the "History of Jefferson Co., MO and Festus, MO" states:

"The Briertons, the Arnibrusters, the Kerrushes, the Waggeners, the Brickeys,

the Millers, the Donnells, and many other names still prominent in the roll call of persons of importance today, appeared then also among the persons who started the wheels of industries in the town. Although there are dozens of other families that could be enumerated as of true importance then, it was unusual to notice how many of the persons interviewed mentioned with affection the name of Kenner as the family that best demonstrated real old fashioned hospitality in this section. The Kenner farm, where the Kenner Hill settlement is now, was a perfect haven for wayfarers. Everybody who traveled through the country in those days stopped at the Kenner home and nobody was ever turned away. Incidentally, the Kenners were always informed on affairs of the state because they came in contact with more out-of-towners than anybody else."

Assemblyman Rodham Kenner

Rodham. (NSSAR Ancestor # P-228666) The official TN bio states: "HOUSE, 5th and 6th General Assemblies, 1803-07; representing Hawkins County; Democrat. Born c. 1759, in Northumberland County, Virginia; son of Francis and Elizabeth (Howard) Kenner. Removed to the Watauga area with his father, both of them having served in the American Revolution; Rodham having been at the Battle of King's Mountain. Farmer; lived near Rogersville for the rest of his life. Married c. 1786 to Malinda Payne; children--Howsen, Ruth, Elizabeth (Mrs. George Savage), Sally Anne (Mrs. Daniel Carmichael), James, Francis, Louisa,

William Rodham, Matilda (Mrs. Alexander Shields), and Polly Kenner (Mrs. William Shields). Killed in a fall from his horse in Hawkins County on October 14 (or 18), 1814; buried in Rodham Kenner Cemetery on the north side of the Holston River, Hawkins County. Father of Dr. William Rodham Kenner, grandfather of John Houston Savage and of Abram Monroe Savage, all sometime members Tennessee General Assembly."

Rodham's son Housen "fought in the Battle of New Orleans, and had a friend standing beside him whose

head was shot off by a cannon ball. This episode filled Housen with horror for as long as he lived." Housen married Susannah Hamblen in 1809 and had 5 children. Housen's son Rodham married Mary Jane Giers and had 9 children. Two of their sons served in the Civil War. Thomas Wilson served as a Captain in the Union Army (Company B, Tennessee 5th Cavalry Regiment) and his brother William Hamblen was a Captain in the Confederate Army under General Robert E. Lee.



Housen Kenner tombstone pictured above. The Rodham Kenner Cemetery is in poor condition, some headstones overturned by cattle.

Winder Kenner

Winder married Mary Davis in 1793 in Hawkins Co and had the following children: Margaret, James, Eskridge, Marena, Elizabeth, William, John, Rebecca and Mary. They moved to Greene Co, MO sometime after the 1830 census and Winder died there Dec 1856. Elizabeth married John Latham McCraw in 1835 in Hawkins

Co and moved to Green Co, MO in 1837. They had a son named William Davis who married Louisiana Armstrong, who ran the old brick Hotel (Now Hale Springs Hotel) in Rogersville, TN. They had 7 children including William Davis II who married Mary Clay and had 3 children. The Clay-Kenner House is named after them.



The Clay-Kenner House

Colonel Eskridge Kenner

Colonel Eskridge (U.S. Daughters of the War of 1812 Ancestor # 22311) was born Aug 1779 and like George Washington is named after Col George Eskridge. In 1807 he married Dorcas Burum. He served during the War of 1812. He apparently moved to Carroll Co AR in 1836. He is listed in the 1850 US Census. Becoming a "First Families of Arkansas" (Antebellum Certificate)! At least four of his children came to AR with him. These were Samuel, William, James Wick and Sophia Eskridge. Eskridge is buried in the Kenner Cemetery about one mile out of Osage on Road 103. He died in

1858 and on his gravestone is inscribed, "My body I commit to the dust and my soul to God that gave it being." Colonel Eskridge's children: Libby, Mahala, Polly, Louisiana, Indiana, Samuel, William W., James Wick and Sophia Eskridge. Samuel married to Matilda E. Foreste on 21 Jul 1850 in Carroll Co and had 12 children. Their son Samuel owned and operated a General Store in the Township of Huntsville, Madison Co AR. During the Civil War though the greater portion of the town was burned, and business of every kind was suspended. It is believed that some of the fires were caused because Samuel housed slaves



in his store. Another son, James Wick was born in 1833 and married Margaret Fancher. He served in the Civil War in Col Nichol's Brigade of Gen Joe Shelby's Division. Shelby was one of the die-hards of the AR troops. He roamed from MS to the MO border and was very instrumental in containing the Union troops in MO. He raided the supply posts of the Union Armies in MO and kept his men supplied. James served as a Lieutenant.



The Kenner Chronicle

<http://davidkenner.wordpress.com/>

<https://www.facebook.com/pages/Kenner-Family/129598733783428>

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Fall Family Vacation

[Overmountain Victory National Historic Trail](#)

[Revolutionary War Weekend Old Burke County Courthouse](#) Morganton, NC

[Mineral Museum](#) Spruce Pine, NC

[Joseph McDowell House](#) Marion, NC

[FestiFall](#) at Walnut Grove Plantation, Roebuck, SC 29376

Oct. 7 [Kings Mountain](#) 2625 Park Road Blacksburg, SC 29702

[Heritage Days Festival](#), Rogersville, TN

[Hale Springs Hotel](#) 110 West Main Street, Rogersville, TN

[The Clay-Kenner House](#) 403 East Main Street, Rogersville, TN

[Sycamore Shoals State Historic Area](#) 1651 West Elk Avenue. Elizabethton, TN